Study Guide

In the style of Edexcel and OCR

To what extent was the West responsible for the creation of the state of Israel?

Exam tips

The cross-references are intended to take you straight to the material that will help you to answer the question.

First, re-read pages 5–14 and 16–21.

To answer this question you need to analyse Western policy towards Palestine/Israel, then other factors that contributed to the creation of the new state and, finally, make a judgement about the relative importance of Western policy in comparison to other factors.

You could examine Western involvement through:

- the Balfour Declaration
- the League of Nations mandate
- British rule in Palestine before the Second World War, e.g. in allowing Jewish immigration and in suppressing the Arab Rebellion after 1936
- US, and wider, international support for the creation of the state of Israel after 1945.

You then need to examine other factors, especially the active part played by Jews in Palestine and abroad, for example:

- maintaining British support up to 1945 (for instance, by serving in the British army)
- use of force by Jews in Palestine to end British rule after 1945
- gaining sympathy and exploiting support (e.g. through propaganda) as a result of the Holocaust
- developing US (and, later, UN) support for a Jewish state during and after the Second World War.

Finally, you will need to arrive at a conclusion which weighs up the importance of Western policy against these other factors. Do this briefly but very clearly, highlighting one or two key points rather than repeating much of what you have said before.